In effect, Khurshid was arguing that India would be a good partner for Iran to work with, because of US comfort with India. Left unsaid but apparent between the lines was the implicit addendum that Iranian partnership with China in “Eurasia” would encounter US suspicion and opposition. Khurshid lamented India’s tendency” to be … careful, cautious and … aloof … despite the enormous potential that it [an Indian–Iran tie] has.” Prime Minister Modi’s May 2016 visit to Iran seems to be part of an Indian effort to heed this admonition and play a more proactive role regarding Iran.

The future of Afghanistan and the China, India, and Russia relationship

Chinese and Indian cooperation with Iran touches on the efforts of both those suitors to influence the future evolution of Afghanistan, expanding their own economic and political role in that pivotally located land. China’s Karakorum Highway, first opened in 1969, and the major upgrading of that road now underway as part of the China Pakistan Economic Corridor, gives China a considerable ability to influence events in Afghanistan. The Karakorum Highway has been a work in progress ever since it opened. Now long sections of the road are being rebuilt, and the entire road will eventually be paralleled by a rail line linking Kashgar with Rawalpindi. In cooperation with Pakistan and using transit routes via that country, China is able to physically link with Afghanistan. China’s infrastructure building over the years have sought to link both Pakistan and Iran more tightly to China with road and rail lines, drawing both of those countries into closer economic ties with China. If China and Pakistan persuade Iran to work with them to shape the evolution of post-America Afghanistan, perhaps by the